

Sample Carb Servings

When a food label is not available, you should measure out the appropriate portions while using a food list showing carb serving sizes, like the one below.

Starch / Grains:

Each = 15 g of carbs (1 carb serving)

- 1 slice or 1 ounce (oz) of bread
- ½ of an English muffin
- ½ of a mini bagel or ¼ of regular bagel
- ½ of a hot dog or hamburger bun
- ¾ C of unsweetened cereal- plain Cheerios, Rice Krispies, Cornflakes
- 4" pancake or waffle
- ½ C of cooked pasta, rice, quinoa, couscous
- ½ C cooked grits, oats/oatmeal
- 3-5 whole wheat crackers
- 3 C popcorn
- 6" corn or 4" flour tortilla

Starchy Vegetables:

Each = 15 g of carbs

- ⅓ cup cassava or plaintain
- ½ cup mashed potatoes or ½ medium baked
- ½ cup corn or 1 medium cob
- ½ cup green peas
- ½ cup parsnips
- ¾ cup pumpkin
- 1 cup winter squash (acorn, butternut)

*Beans are a starchy protein:

- ½ C - lentils, kidney, lima, navy, pinto, etc.

Milk / Dairy:

Each = 12 g of carbs (1 carb serving)

- 1 C (8 ounces) of milk — (all types)
- 1 C of *plain* yogurt
- 1 C of *plain* or vanilla soy milk

Fruit:

Each = 15 g of carbs (1 carb serving)

- One small fruit (4 oz)
- ½ C of canned fruit (in own juice)
- ¼ C or 2 tablespoons of dried fruit
- 17 small grapes (3 oz or ½ cup)
- ½ C of fruit juice
- 1 ¼ C of Strawberries or melon
- 1 tablespoon (Tbsp) of jelly or jam
- 1 C black berries or raspberries
- ½ medium banana or mango

Sweets & Desserts:

Each = 15 g of carbs (1 carb serving)

- 2-inch square cake (unfrosted)
- 2 small cookies – 2 ¼ inches
- ½ cup ice cream or frozen yogurt
- ¼ cup of sherbert or sorbet
- 1 tablespoon syrup or honey
- 2 tablespoons *light* syrup
- 1/6 of 8 inch pie (45g Carbs)
- 1 muffin - 4 oz. (60g Carbs)

Combination Foods

Each = 30 g of carbs (2 carb servings)

- 1 cup of Casseroles & mixed foods (spaghetti, mac 'n cheese, etc)

*These are general guidelines for carbohydrate servings. **Always check the food label.** Food manufacturers may add ingredients to foods, which can increase or decrease the total amount of carbohydrates.

Low Carb Small Meal/Snack Ideas

(Mix: Carb + Protein) Always add a protein....

- 3 cups fat-free popcorn with 3 Tbsp nuts
- 4-5 whole grain cracker with low fat cheese
- 3 graham cracker squares with 1 Tbsp peanut butter
- 1 slice whole grain bread with slice of turkey, cheese, mustard
- 1-4" flour tortilla with salsa
- 6 saltine crackers with peanut butter
- 2-3 celery sticks with 1 Tbsp peanut butter and 1 Tbsp raisins
- ½ cup sugar snap peas and 2 Tbsp hummus
- ½ cup tuna or egg salad with ½ of a whole wheat pita or 4-5 crackers
- Light English muffin with 1 Tbsp nut butter or cheese
- ½ cup low-fat cottage cheese & 1 small fruit cup (in water or own juice)
- ½ banana with 1 Tbsp peanut butter
- 10 multigrain Wheat Thins with string cheese
- 4 oz no sugar added Rice pudding and 2 Tbsp nuts
- ½ cup carrots with 2 Tbsp light ranch dip
- 1 hard-boiled egg with 1 small piece of fruit
- 1 regular Eggo Waffle with 1 Tbsp nut butter
- ½ cup apple sauce with 2 Tbsp mixed nuts
- 1 cup cucumber with 2 Tbsp hummus
- 1 sweet pepper with 2 Tbsp hummus
- 1 rice cake with low sugar jam or peanut butter
- 4 oz light yogurt with rolled up deli meat or cheese and 2 Tbsp salsa
- 1 slice whole wheat toast, 1 slice cheese and 1 hard cooked egg
- 1 cup sugar free jello with ½ cup fruit – add a protein
- 8 animal crackers or 2 pretzel rods with 1 Tbsp peanut butter.
- Beef jerky trail mix- beef jerky, almonds, cashews, walnuts, pecans, edamame
- Cottage cheese and fruit; or cottage cheese and celery
- Greek yogurt and celery
- Greek yogurt and nuts
- Sandwich meat and cheese rolls
- Devil eggs- add tuna in center for something different
- Muffin eggs cups with meat, spinach and cheese
- Flatout wraps with veggies or meat.
- Tuna packets with celery or peppers